





The food is less mysterious than the decor, and the presentation of each dish is testimony to chef Abhinav Sharma's artistry





FOOD

Star Rating

Does the stamp of celebrity translate into serpentine queues for a restaurant? Neuma, **Karan Johar's** new venture in Colaba, helps us with some answers



The restaurant business is tough. And when you aim to replace a much-loved property, comparisons are inevitable. No wonder then that the gorgeous colonial bungalow that housed Rahul Akerkar's Indigo has remained vacant since the restaurant closed down in 2018. Finally, there was some excitement when news came in some weeks ago that filmmaker Karan Johar had taken over the Mandlik Road space to open a restaurant of his own, but, predictably, it was impossible to get a table at Neuma for the first couple of weeks—it's still virtually impossible (but that's also because no one ever answers their phone).

Decorated by architect Ashiesh Shah, the restaurant is pretty, in parts. But it's also divided in distinct sections, for some reason, with no unifying theme. The Garden Bar, Sun Porch and Courtyard, the central dining room, share a minimalist aesthetic, but the other rooms here seem completely disconnected to these three. The Courtyard, with its striking black-and-white flooring and sparse decor, is sandwiched